

Annotated Example Prompt

The real brief from the Lesson 2.4 demo — a PRD kickoff for a B2B scheduling tool's notification-digest feature. Same five blocks from the Brief Anatomy lesson, with notes on why each one is built the way it is.

R Role

You're a senior PM at a B2B scheduling tool — shared team booking pages, round-robin routing, calendar sync. Our customers are RevOps and customer-success teams at mid-market SaaS companies.

WHY THIS WORKS

One line, not a paragraph of backstory. Just enough for the model to adopt the right vantage point and stakes — a longer persona wouldn't sharpen the output.

T Task

Draft a PRD for a notification digest feature.

WHY THIS WORKS

A single, plain ask. Stacking two or three asks here ("draft a PRD and also suggest a rollout plan and...") blurs the output — one instruction per prompt lands cleaner.

C Context

Today we send one email per event — every booking, reschedule, and cancellation is its own message. Schedulers who own 20+ meetings a week are drowning. Our top support theme this quarter is "too many emails," and in our last two churn interviews both admins said they'd turned notifications off entirely — so they also missed the cancellations that actually mattered. We want a digest: batch the low-urgency notifications into one scheduled summary, while genuinely time-sensitive ones still go instantly. This is for the individual scheduler first, admins second.

WHY THIS WORKS

This is the block that carries the weight. Specific numbers, a named support theme, and real churn-interview detail — things the model could never guess. It's what turns a generic PRD into one grounded in this product.

F Format

Standard PRD — problem statement, goals, non-goals, user stories, key flows, success metrics, open questions. Keep it tight.

WHY THIS WORKS

Names the exact section order up front, so the shape is settled before drafting starts — not negotiated after the fact in a second round of edits.

G Guardrails

Don't invent success metrics or numbers — leave them as placeholders for me to fill from our baseline. This brief deliberately leaves two decisions open — the default digest cadence and exactly what counts as "urgent." Before you draft anything, ask me the one or two clarifying questions you most need answered, then stop and wait for my reply. Flag every assumption you make.

WHY THIS WORKS

Three jobs in one block: what not to fabricate (metrics), two decisions left open on purpose so the gap is visible, and the line that turns a guess into a question — **"ask me first, then stop."**

WHAT HAPPENED NEXT

Because cadence and "urgent" were left open, the model asked before drafting instead of guessing — the guardrail worked. After the first draft, the interrogation prompt **"What did you assume that I didn't tell you?"** surfaced six hidden assumptions, three of which would have changed the spec (channel scope, whether invitees get digests too, the exact definition of "urgent"). Watch the full build in Lesson 2.4.